Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Zambia unlocks digital earnings for creators** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026 ZAMBIA

  Zambia's technology and youth ministries are developing a framework for local content creators to earn from digital platforms, and are talking to Meta, TikTok and Google about the legal and technical arrangements. The President named it a priority when opening the 14th National Assembly, and a national database of creators is being compiled. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **We regulate cybercriminals, now it's time to regulate the platforms they use** — Business Day, 12 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Two authors summarise their report for a free-expression campaign, arguing that South Africa should regulate the platforms cybercriminals use by borrowing from the European Digital Services Act: notice-and-action, trusted flaggers, systemic-risk duties and transparency reports. It is opinion; the report itself is not held. *Also under Legislation and regulation and Cybersecurity*.

- **UCC Reviews Crackdown on Unauthorised Wi-Fi Operators After Complaints** — Nile Post, 12 October 2026 UGANDA

  Uganda's communications regulator said it is reviewing its enforcement against unauthorised Wi-Fi and hotspot resellers after complaints from operators. A public notice was promised within the week. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **TASIS outlines governance plans for 24 million Sudanese** — The Sudan Times, 12 October 2026 SUDAN

  The prime minister of Sudan's TASIS-backed administration announced plans for a national smart identity card for banking, judicial and administrative transactions in the territory it runs, alongside new vehicle registration, licensing and customs procedures. He put that territory at about 90 localities and 24 million people, figures that are not independently verified. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS*.

- **Sam George tasks KNUST to develop Twi AI model as Ghana plans local-language artificial intelligence** — MyJoyOnline, 12 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's communications minister said national AI language models will be built locally, tasking a Kumasi university to lead a Twi model and other universities to lead other Ghanaian languages. Voice interfaces for farmers and telemedicine are planned; no budget or timetable was given. *Also under AI*.

- **Mozambique: Government updating national cybersecurity strategy** — Club of Mozambique, 12 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

Mozambique's communications minister said the national cybersecurity strategy for 2026 to 2030 is being updated and will be the main instrument for implementing the Cybersecurity Act. He put cyber incidents recorded in 2025 at about 39,600 and urged operators of critical infrastructure to set up their incident response teams. *Also under Cybersecurity*.

- **Mozambique Regulator Pushes Postal Sector Reform to Tackle Informal Deliveries** — Tech Africa News, 12 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Mozambique's communications regulator held its first postal operators forum on 9 October and called for the sector to be formalised and modernised as e-commerce grows. The country has 38 licensed postal operators, and the regulator named unlicensed delivery through digital platforms as a problem for oversight and consumer protection. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **Government gives postal sector 90 days for transformation plan** — The Herald, 12 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister gave her ministry, the regulator and the postal operator 90 days to produce a costed plan for the postal and courier sector to 2030, with quarterly reporting. She also directed operators to comply with the Cyber and Data Protection Act and required pilots of artificial intelligence and drones to carry a named lead, a timetable and measurable benefits. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Access to services*.

- **Chad moves towards adopting its national artificial intelligence strategy | East African Policy Observer** — East African Policy Observer, 12 October 2026 CHAD

  Chad held a pre-validation workshop on its draft national artificial-intelligence strategy, drafted with the UN Economic Commission for Africa. The draft covers 2027 to 2035 and names agriculture, public administration, security and defence, education and health as priority sectors. *Also under AI*.

- **Big Tech or public good? What Cape Town's data centre battle means for residents** — Daily Maverick, 12 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  One of the organisations appealing against land-use rights for a planned hyperscale data centre in Cape Town argues that the mayor should uphold the appeal because the application did not state the site's water use, emissions or jobs. It writes that the appeal went before the city's advisory panel on 12 October and that the mayor then has 90 days to decide. *Also under Data Storage and Energy*.

Legislation and regulation

- **LTA Holds Public Consultation on Draft Infrastructure Regulations** — Liberian Observer, 12 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Liberia's telecommunications authority consulted internet service providers, mobile operators and licensees on draft regulations for deploying, sharing, managing and decommissioning telecoms infrastructure. The draft text is not held. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **Gabon updates digital payment laws to support regional interoperability** — Biometric Update, 12 October 2026 GABON

  An account of Gabon's bill ratifying its digital payments ordinance ties it to the regional central bank's interoperability rules. It puts the national merchant QR scheme at more than 3,273 merchants and 1,382 GIMAC QR codes as of July. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech*.

- **We regulate cybercriminals, now it's time to regulate the platforms they use** — Business Day, 12 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Data protection

- **Preparing Ghana's health records for the digital future** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 12 October 2026 GHANA

  The Ghana Health Service, supported by WHO, convened a national workshop to revise its Medical Records Strategy and Operational Guidelines, written nearly a decade ago. The revision is to cover electronic medical records, data governance, interoperability, cybersecurity and the use of artificial intelligence in healthcare. *Also under Standards, Data Exchange and Sectoral management information systems.*

- **Nyaho Medical Centre referred to CID over allegedly expired data protection registration** — MyJoyOnline, 12 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's Data Protection Commission directed an Accra hospital to report to the police criminal investigations department over an expired data protection registration certificate, after an enforcement operation on 12 October. How long the registration had lapsed was not stated.

- **How Absa Bank's employee data leak brought down multi-billion business** — The Standard, 12 October 2026 KENYA

  A former senior manager at a Kenyan bank testified, in a Sh1.5 billion data breach suit against it, that a credit manager disclosed a borrower's loan distress to a third party. He said the bank's legal department recommended no action because it saw no material risk of abuse.

- **CA to set up central database to track recycled phone numbers** — Daily Nation, 12 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's communications regulator said it will set up a central database of recycled phone numbers, which operators must update every three months. Banks, fintechs and bulk message senders would check it before sending account messages to a number. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS.*

Regional collaboration

- **LESOTHO JOINED A CONTINENTAL ALLIANCE TO ADVANCE AI, DATA AND DIGITAL SKILLS PAVING THE WAY FOR THE ESTABLISHMENT OF THE SMART AFRICA DIGITAL ACADEMY. - Government of Lesotho** — Government of Lesotho, 12 October 2026 LESOTHO

  Lesotho's communications minister took part in the 21st Smart Africa Alliance meeting, and government said efforts are under way to establish the alliance's digital academy in the country. Lesotho joined the alliance in 2025. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Internet : qu'est-ce que la liaison par fibre avec la RDC peut apporter à la Centrafrique** — Agence Ecofin, 12 October 2026 CAR DRC

  The digital-economy ministers of the Central African Republic and DR Congo agreed in Moscow on 8 October on the need to carry out a fibre interconnection between the two countries, which would give the Central African Republic a third international route, toward the submarine cable landing at Moanda. No timetable or financing was announced. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **BCEAO to Double Mobile Money Account Limit to CFAF 4 Million** — Togo First, 12 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

The West African central bank's new instruction doubles the cap on electronic money one client may hold at one issuer to FCFA 4 million, from a limit set in 2015. Issuers must now keep at least 65% of their float in demand deposits, down from 75%. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **'Morocco CyberSecurity Week' Kicks off in Rabat** — Maroc.ma (MAP), 12 October 2026 MOROCCO AFRICA

  Morocco's information systems security directorate is hosting a three-day cybersecurity event in Rabat from 12 to 14 October, with an ITU exercise drawing representatives of about thirty countries. The African Network of Cybersecurity Authorities meets on its sidelines. *Also under Cybersecurity and Training and skills.*

Standards

- **Preparing Ghana's health records for the digital future** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 12 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **South Sudan calls for digital governance measures at Moscow Forum** — Eye Radio, 12 October 2026 SOUTH SUDAN

  The head of South Sudan's Media Authority, leading the country's delegation at a digital forum in Moscow, said the government needs to put in place measures bringing digital technology into public administration and to understand the risks and benefits of artificial intelligence. No instrument or timetable was announced. *Also under AI.*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **RDC : la 5G en préparation, près de 7 Congolais sur 10 restent hors ligne** — wearetech.africa, 12 October 2026 DRC

  DR Congo's government is preparing a commercial 5G launch, which the telecommunications minister said in late September it was working to make available before the end of 2026. The article sets that against internet use of about 30.5% of the population at the end of 2025 and mobile internet coverage of 45%. *Also under Digital divides.*

- **Botswana invests in highway connectivity** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026 BOTSWANA

  Botswana's universal service fund, working with one mobile operator, has deployed 12 mobile broadband and voice sites along the 1,900km Trans-Kalahari Highway at a cost of P34.5 million, the communications minister said. Infrastructure sharing with the other two operators is to extend coverage by the end of the next financial year. *Also under Rural digital data capture and Access to services.*

- **Algérie : la fibre optique dépasse 4 millions d'abonnements, les tarifs chutent de 76 %** — Agence Ecofin, 12 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Algeria's fibre-to-the-home subscriptions passed 4 million in early October, from 53,000 in June 2020, on the posts minister's figures. The monthly price of an offer of 100 Mbit/s or more has fallen 76%, and the target is more than 4.4 million by the end of the year. *Also under Access to services.*

- **UCC Reviews Crackdown on Unauthorised Wi-Fi Operators After Complaints** — Nile Post, 12 October 2026 UGANDA

Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **LTA Holds Public Consultation on Draft Infrastructure Regulations** — Liberian Observer, 12 October 2026 LIBERIA

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Data Storage

- **Big Tech or public good? What Cape Town's data centre battle means for residents** — Daily Maverick, 12 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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Energy

- **Big Tech or public good? What Cape Town's data centre battle means for residents** — Daily Maverick, 12 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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Cybersecurity

- **한국 해외원조인데...코이카, 디지털 ODA로 중국 IT장비 지원** — Yonhap News Agency (연합뉴스), 12 October 2026 SENEGAL CAMEROON RWANDA EGYPT

  A South Korean MP said Korea's aid agency had supplied Chinese-made equipment to e-government projects it funded abroad, among them Senegal's National Assembly system, Egypt's public e-procurement system, Cameroon's e-procurement system and Rwanda's e-receipt and tax portal. The agency told him it has no criteria for judging whether equipment comes from a high-risk supply chain. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and China activities.*

- **Chinese firms banned in US are watching Botswana's citizens, banks and borders** — Sunday Standard, 12 October 2026 BOTSWANA

  A newspaper investigation reports that two Chinese surveillance-camera makers have a substantial footprint in Botswana, from the police surveillance network to a nationwide banking CCTV system and public facilities. Only the opening of the article is held; the detail is behind a paywall. *Also under China activities and Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

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DPI

Data Exchange

- **Preparing Ghana's health records for the digital future** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 12 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **6,308 NIDA cards remain uncollected in Zanzibar** — The Guardian (IPP Media), 12 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Tanzania's home affairs minister said 6,308 national identity cards printed for Zanzibar residents had not been collected. He said government is considering fines for late collection and may require the physical card for services that now accept the identity number alone. *Also under Access to services.*

- **TASIS outlines governance plans for 24 million Sudanese** — The Sudan Times, 12 October 2026 SUDAN

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- **CA to set up central database to track recycled phone numbers** — Daily Nation, 12 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Airtel Money begins trading on London Stock Exchange after an oversubscribed IPO** — The Financial Express, 12 October 2026 AFRICA

  Airtel Money began conditional trading on the London Stock Exchange on 9 October after an oversubscribed offer in which existing shareholders sold 270 million shares, raising about US$703 million. The shares ended just below the offer price on the first day, and unconditional dealings were due on 14 October. *Also under ICT Industry.*

- **Gabon updates digital payment laws to support regional interoperability** — Biometric Update, 12 October 2026 GABON

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **BCEAO to Double Mobile Money Account Limit to CFAF 4 Million** — Togo First, 12 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Registries

- **LESOTHO GOVERNMENT IS POISED TO BENEFIT SIGNIFICANTLY FROM WORLD BANK AS IT'S ON A VITAL MISSION TO TACKLE YOUTH UNEMPLOYMENT THROUGH INNOVATIVE DIGITAL PUBLIC WORKS PROGRAMS. - Government of Lesotho** — Government of Lesotho, 12 October 2026 LESOTHO

  A World Bank urban and land team told Lesotho's communications ministry it is interested in supporting a nationwide digital address system, in talks that also covered geospatial data for planning and digital public works for young people. No commitment or amount was stated.

Sectoral management information systems

- **MRA Credits ATAF Support for Tax Administration Reforms, Data Improvements** — Liberian Observer, 12 October 2026 MALAWI

The Malawi Revenue Authority said it is building a second integrated tax administration system in-house and is still seeking funding for it. It credited its electronic invoicing system, enforced from 1 May, with part of a rise in average monthly VAT collections from MK66.73 billion to MK81.24 billion. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Key Ration Card Services Now Available on Digital Egypt** — SceneNow, 12 October 2026 EGYPT

  Egypt has put key ration card services on the Digital Egypt platform: heads of household can update card data, replace or activate cards, transfer a file between governorates and add family members. The data-update service is being introduced in Port Said for an initial three months before other governorates. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Beyond the Pinpoints: Making Disability Services Visible in Zanzibar** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP Tanzania), 12 October 2026 TANZANIA

  UNDP says a tool it piloted in Unguja to map disability care and support services has been integrated into Zanzibar's Jumuishi management information system. The mapping found 32 providers, 30 of them in one region. *Also under Access to services*.

- **Preparing Ghana's health records for the digital future** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 12 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **«Water Tank and Water Pump Grant Scheme» : Les demandes d'aide pour les réservoirs d'eau bientôt en ligne** — L'Express (Maurice), 12 October 2026 MAURITIUS

  Mauritius's ICT ministry says it is building an online application platform with the Central Water Authority for a household water tank and pump grant announced on 9 October. Access terms are to follow.

- **Yamoussoukro : Le Sénat modernise sa 2e session, le vote électronique activé** — Linfodrome, 12 October 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Côte d'Ivoire's Senate opened its second ordinary session of 2026 with attendance recorded in real time instead of a roll call, amendments filed online and proceedings archived automatically. Electronic voting was trialled the same day, with training for senators on 13 to 16 October.

- **한국 해외원조인데…코이카, 디지털 ODA로 중국 IT장비 지원** — Yonhap News Agency (연합뉴스), 12 October 2026 SENEGAL CAMEROON RWANDA EGYPT

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Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

- **Botswana invests in highway connectivity** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026 BOTSWANA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Technology

AI

- **Zambia Pilots AI Career Guidance Platform to Bridge Youth Skills Gap** — Tech Africa News, 12 October 2026 ZAMBIA

  Zambia's technology ministry is piloting Njila.ai, an artificial-intelligence career-guidance platform, in the technical and vocational training system under a World Bank-backed skills project. The pilot is expected to reach more than 17,000 young people, and feedback is to decide any wider rollout. *Also under Training and skills.*

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Access to services

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Geopolitics

China activities

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This bulletin is produced automatically at the end of each data collection sweep but only includes items published on the day cited in the edition, and the previous day. Items published in the last month can be found on the country pages. The links to all items stored in the corpus can be found in the catalogue.

Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country pages and the monthly reports.